



Finance Planning
Mortgage & Protection



April 2025

Continual Professional Development

Welcome to the Finance Planning monthly round-up newsletter for April 2025,

Some very impressive figures in the first quarter of 2025 so well done to all. Some exciting technology enhancements coming soon with several of them outlined in this edition. There have also been quite a few recent compliance updates and alongside some important Mortgage, Protection and Performance updates this newsletter is well worth a few minutes of your time.

Thank you.

David



Compliance News 08/2025 (Sourcing tracker products)

To assist with your sourcing results correctly reflecting the cheapest tracker products, please remember to include the “calculation period” of say 2 or 5 years within the “configure true cost” section of the Acre sourcing.

Compliance News 09/2025 (Debt consolidation)

Please ensure that where your client tells you they are clearing debt from a capital raise, that they do indeed reduce or repay that debt. Failure to do so is a breach of their mortgage conditions – and lenders do check up on these things!

Compliance News 10/2025 (Met Life products)

We have a new insurer with a new range of products – Met Life. As a Protection Adviser, if you wish to be able to recommend these products then you need to watch a training webinar on how their products work, and then you will be granted an agency. Speak to Joe Streek who is the Met Life BDM for more information, or contact Matt Stephens.

Compliance News 11/2025 (Acre cases stuck in pre-recommendation or pre-application)

As a reminder we have 10 working days to fully package a case on Acre and publish/send the Suitability Report (SR). The SR cannot be sent to a client until it has been published in Acre, and so please be checking your Acre pipeline to ensure your submitted cases have been progressed accordingly. And please ensure the client has been sent the SR.

FCA update on their Business Plan for 2025/26

The FCA has published its Business Plan for 2025/26 which confirms its work programme for the year ahead. This is based on the following 4 strategic priorities:

1. A smarter regulator: more efficient and more effective
2. Supporting growth
3. Helping consumers navigate their financial lives
4. Fighting financial crime

If you would like to know the details behind these high-level statements, then please speak with Pete who can update you.

FCA update on 'Loan to Income' flow in mortgage lending

The FCA and the PRA has set out a joint consultation paper in which they propose amendments to the Loan to Income flow threshold for mortgage lenders. Currently, the LTI flow limits the number of mortgages made at a 4.5x loan-to-income ratio to no more than 15% of new business, but this new consultation paper is challenging some of these existing controls.

Renters Rights Bill

This Bill, also known as the Renters Reform Bill, is a once in a generation opportunity to overhaul the private renting sector. It is very important to all landlords and tenants, as we have not seen proposed changes like this since Margaret Thatcher's Government introduced the fixed term Assured Tenancy and Assured Shorthold Tenancy back in 1989. I'm just saying that to emphasise how little has changed to protect landlords or tenants in recent decades.

The Bill is currently being examined by the House of Lords, and it is expected to come into force later this year. Below is a summary of the key points of the Bill, as it is important that you, your landlords and their tenants all understand these changes that are coming. I suspect that most landlords who rent using a letting agent will be well versed on this material, but we as Advisers might not be:

Key Components	
Abolition of Section 21 'no-fault' evictions	Landlords can no longer evict tenants without a valid legal reason. This applies to both new and existing tenancies, giving renters more security.
Periodic tenancies	All tenancies will now be periodic from the outset, replacing the fixed term assured shorthold tenancy (AST). This means there is no set end date, and the tenancy will automatically roll over on a monthly basis, giving tenants greater flexibility to end the agreement.
Extension of Awaab's Law	Awaab's Law, initially for social housing, is extended to the private sector, allowing tenants to challenge unsafe living conditions, such as damp and mould.
Ban on rental bidding wars	Landlords and letting agents must set a fixed asking rent, and tenants cannot be asked to bid above that amount. This aims to prevent tenants from being forced to engage in competitive bidding for properties.
Limit on rent increases	Rent can only be raised once a year and must reflect the market rate. Mid-tenancy rent hikes are no longer permitted.
Application of the Decent Homes Standard	For the first time, private landlords must ensure properties meet the Decent Homes Standard. This includes proper maintenance and safety with penalties of up to £7,000 for non-compliance.
New possession grounds for landlords	Landlords can repossess properties if they need to sell or move in themselves, but only after the first 12 months of tenancy, with four months' notice required.
No blanket bans on benefit recipients or families	Landlords can no longer refuse to rent to tenants based on whether they receive benefits or have children, ensuring fairer access to housing.
Private or Rented Sector Database	A new database will be introduced to inform tenants about landlord obligations and help councils enforce compliance.

Pets in rental properties	Tenants have the right to request to keep pets, and landlords cannot unreasonably refuse. Landlords may ask tenants to take out insurance to cover any damage caused by the pets.
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Vulnerable Persons – a reminder

Please remember to be looking for customers in potentially vulnerable circumstances so that you can provide them with the additional support they may need to help them in their decision making. It is important that all clients get the same good outcomes. You must then record your client as vulnerable in Acre, adding in a sentence or two about their situation and what you have done to help them.

Fraud Prevention – Top Tips

You often hear lenders saying how brokers are the first line of defence in fraud prevention. And this is true. But to be this line of defence, it is really important that we examine the client documentation presented to us, and then accurately present it to lenders. With this in mind, you are reminded of the following:

1. You must accurately present the applicants situation to the lender, including their employments, their income and their commitments (failure to do so could make you complicit in mortgage fraud!)
2. You are encouraged to upload notes to the lender to explain client circumstances where you feel this will assist the lending decision
3. You must examine closely the client's documentation to ensure it is accurate and is plausible
4. You can utilise the following resources to help further authenticate an applicant's income:
 - a. Google Street View to check the employer's premises
 - b. Do payslips and bank statements match?
 - c. Are there family links with the employer?
 - d. Check employer on Companies House
 - e. Use a tax calculator to verify numbers on payslips
 - f. If in doubt, ask for a P60
 - g. Does the age and experience match with the employment and salary?
 - h. Question recent significant pay rises
 - i. Does the employer have an internet presence?
 - j. Google searches for occupation registers as many occupations now have online registers, such as accountants, solicitors, all of the medial professions, and even mortgage brokers! So, if your client works in the NHS or is a dental nurse, for example, they will be on an online register to authenticate their role
 - k. Does the story make sense? – plausibility!
 - l. If in doubt, speak to a colleague, or Pete for a second opinion, or report a SAR!

protectionnews

Our good news story this month comes courtesy of an adviser who's been with FPG for many years...

"I had some clients who after completing on their mortgage and protection they advised me that they didn't see any value in my ongoing service, and that they would call me if I was ever required. This is NOT the norm thankfully with all my other clients!

Recently they called to say that a few years ago the wife had been diagnosed with MS, and did I think they could have claimed on their CIC policy which we took out when we did the mortgage. We got a claim underway and within 2 months I'm happy to report it's all been paid out. A case of better late than never, and perhaps now they may reflect on the fact that there would have been added value in allowing the annual reviews to continue!

It has however made - in her words - a 'HUGE difference to their lives', so thank you Legal & General!"

TOP Protection Updates:

Zurich – In their continued effort to improve their Income Protection product Zurich have made a big change to their policies. They will now cover up to 65% of the first £60,000 of the customer's gross income plus up to 45% of their gross income above £60,000, subject to a maximum of £20,000 per month. Great news!

Guardian – Probably our biggest update this month was Guardian officially announcing their long-rumoured CIC improvements. The list of changes is too big for this newsletter but you can follow this link to find out more and Paul Newick our new BDM is on call pretty much whenever to answer questions - https://adviser.guardian1821.co.uk/biggest-upgrade-yet/?utm_source=pardot&utm_medium=email&utm_campaign=cover-upgrade&utm_content=CTA1

A reminder of the Protection Helpdesk

A reminder that our Protection Service Provider (Zenith PMS) has set up a Protection Helpdesk where we can send them our hard-to-place protection cases, for them to see if they can find you an insurer for your client. They work a bit like a mortgage packager. They will conduct some underwriting research for you, but then you need to place the case as normal. This is a free service to utilise. The Helpdesk can be contacted on protectionhelpdesk@sbg.co.uk and 0161 527 0193 (Doug Wilson) and 0161 527 0118 (Chris Broomhead).

mortgageneWS

In this mortgage update we are minimising the number of product or specific criteria changes as you can review these from the vast array of emails you receive from lenders each day.

Coventry for intermediaries

Coventry have confirmed that all new customer mortgage business should be submitted through their MSO system. If you submit any business via the 'existing customer business' system, it'll be cancelled and must be re-submitted via MSO.

Generation Home

The income booster product can now be used for re-mortgages and home movers and not just FTB's.

NatWest

NatWest have launched a joint borrower sole proprietor mortgage they are calling the Family-Backed Mortgage. It has a range of different eligibility criteria to take note of that was emailed out on 28th April.

Skipton

Skipton have launched a new product 'Delayed Start Mortgage', no mortgage repayments are due for the first three months after completion, interest does accrue from day one however.

Proc Fee Payment Route

Please do NOT select PMS when applying for a mortgage. Please always select L&G Mortgage Cub, as we always have. (For your information, PMS are our protection service provider – Zenith PMS.)

performance

Mortgages – Adviser League Table for April 2025

Congratulations to **Rob Chart** for leading the way with 40 mortgage applications.

<u>Adviser</u>	<u>Cases</u>
Rob Chart	40
Carl Thorne	27
Dan Fletcher	25
Jack Savory	23
Colin Mackay	20
Claire Lipscomb	19
Paul Gent	18
Cathy Rafferty	18
Phil Smith	17
Emily Chattaway	16
Jack Humphries	16
Andy Poustie	16
Jonathan Peachey	15
Peter Stickley	14
Joanne Pope	14
Paul Ripley	13
Phil James	13
Dan Grant	12
Hannah Logan-Hughes	12
Joe Maskell	12
Dipes Rai	11
Pertu Balan	11
Samita Rai	10
Dave Jacob	10
Karen Mills	10
Matt Stephens	10
Jim Maye	10
Chris Williams	10

Protection (protection and GI combined) – Adviser League Table for April 2025

A very impressive month for Paul Gent with 44 submitted protection applications.

<u>Adviser</u>	<u>Cases</u>
Paul Gent	44
Jane Hutchinson	22
Clare Mann	21

Congratulations to everyone who has featured on last month's league tables

Should anyone feel their applications are not being calculated properly, please speak to your Sales Manager as it might mean those cases you have submitted to a lender or insurer have not been recorded as such on Acre yet and we can show you how to fix that.

Lender completions

We thought you would find it interesting to see some of the completion figures for our top 10 lenders. The below figures are for Q1 this year

1. Halifax	£60,456,131	228 Cases
2. Nationwide	£59,959,061	250 Cases
3. Barclays	£55,959,061	216 Cases
4. NatWest	£52,764,445	223 Cases
5. Santander	£37,852,584	157 Cases
6. HSBC	£27,519,655	107 Cases
7. Skipton	£16,864,146	62 Cases
8. Accord	£12,452,896	39 Cases
9. TSB	£10,361,285	39 Cases
10. BM Solutions	£10,344,575	59 Cases



Well done to the following advisers who have all submitted million-pound cases this year. Cases added in the last month are shown in [blue](#).

Mortgage cases

Paul Goodey	£3,881,250
Romi Pal	£3,207,525
Chris Williams	£2,377,875
Paul Goodey	£2,306,000
Oliver Cunningham	£1,510,450
Romi Pal	£1,385,000
Carrie Millin	£1,335,897
Victoria Wescott	£1,300,074
Trevor Farley	£1,237,393
Rob Chart	£1,234,503
Ellis Featherbe	£1,207,000
Jonathon Peachey	£1,200,000
Marion Hunnisett	£1,125,000
Cathy Rafferty	£1,150,000
Phoebe Wight	£1,105,000
Cathy Rafferty	£1,020,000
Paul Goodey	£1,015,521
Jim Maye	£1,014,681

Protection cases

Paul Gent	Exec IPB £1,240,320
Paul Gent	Exec IPB £1,164,801
Paul Gent	IPB £1,128,204
Richard Lucy	Life £1,000,000

As with the mortgage and protection figures if you feel an application you have made should be referenced here, please speak to your sales manager to confirm if it is showing on Acre correctly.

The logo for 'goodnews' is displayed in a dark blue, lowercase, sans-serif font. The word 'good' is in a bolder weight than 'news'. The logo is positioned on the left side of a blue rectangular background. To the right of the text, there is a graphic element consisting of two overlapping triangles: a larger orange triangle pointing downwards and a smaller blue triangle pointing upwards, creating a white space between them.

FPG Anniversaries

So far in 2025 we have seen some very significant milestones reached in terms of service within the Finance Planning Group especially as this is the 25th year of The Finance Planning Group. A big thank you to everyone listed below for your hard work and dedication for however long you've been with us.

- Adam Hayward – 22 years
- Pete Burgess – 18 years
- Joe Maskell – 11 years
- Dan Walsh – 9 years
- Petru Balan – 5 years
- Surakshya Rai – 1 year

I have been compiling these dates from several sources and have tried to be as accurate as possible but apologies in advance if anybody has been missed from this list that should have been recognised for a work anniversary please let me know so I can rectify it.

Upcoming Birthdays

Happy Birthday to everybody celebrating in May.

- Andrew Bramley
- Cathy Rafferty
- David Bland
- Eddie Rozario
- Jill Craigs
- John Steer
- Lea Pulling
- Lee Harper
- Lynn Strange
- Matthew Young
- Nicki Hart
- Oliver Cunningham
- Paul Gent



miscellaneous

FPG Zoom Meetings

A reminder that our weekly zoom meetings hosted by Dan and Mark continue each Monday at 4pm. It's a great way to keep your knowledge updated and to gain the required CPD!